

ing plant in northern Italy. It mentioned that the plant would utilise resources and expertise from both sides to develop and market energy storage products in Europe, creating a new base for innovative energy storage solutions. The production of the cobalt-free lithium-iron-phosphate batteries will begin later this year.

Ørsted joins hands with SOLARCYCLE to recycle solar modules

Leading clean energy company Ørsted recently announced a partnership with SOLARCYCLE, a technology-based solar recycling company, to process and recycle Ørsted's end-of-life solar modules from its projects across the US. The company-released statement mentioned that the recycling services agreement supports Ørsted's global commitment, effective immediately, to reuse or recycle 100% of solar panels that reach an end-of-life status. It is noteworthy that Ørsted had signed a recycling contract for thin-film modules with First Solar in 2021. The current deal provides Ørsted with a portfolio-wide recycling solution for crystalline silicon (c-Si) solar modules.

Siltronic and Axpo Solutions forge partnership for solar energy

In a recent update from Germany, silicon wafers manufacturer Siltronic announced that it has entered into a partnership with Swiss utility Axpo Solutions for the procurement of solar energy. The annual contract volume is 60 gigawatt-hours, which roughly corresponds to the annual electricity consumption of about 20,000 households, said the company. The parties have signed a long-term power purchase agreement (PPA) for a period of ten years, starting in 2024. Siltronic operates two production sites in Germany (Freiburg and Burghausen) and plans to power these facilities with green energy. The company believes that after this deal it will be able to cover around one-fifth of its electricity demand in Germany.

NVIDIA shares soar after chipmaker forecasts \$11 billion surge in sales

Shares of US semiconductor giant NVIDIA jumped by nearly 26%, raising its market capitalisation by \$184 billion recently,

after the company reported a stronger-than-expected forecast for the quarter that ends in July. The chipmaker said that it expected sales to reach \$11 billion in the current quarter, which is 50% more than Wall Street's estimate of \$7.2 billion. The company's overall profit jumped by 26% year-over-year to \$2.04 billion.

China and South Korea to strengthen cooperation on chips

China's Commerce Ministry issued a statement saying that the Chinese and South Korean governments have agreed to strengthen dialogue and cooperation on semiconductor industry supply chains amid broader global concerns over chip supplies, sanctions, and national security. At the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation (APEC) trade ministers' meeting in Detroit, Chinese Commerce Minister Wang Wentao and South Korean trade minister Ahn Duk-Geun exchanged views on maintaining the stability of the industrial supply chain and strengthening cooperation in bilateral, regional, and multilateral fields.

British Gas unveils A5 notebook-size Hive EV Charger

As the newest addition to its line of smart home charging solutions, British Gas has announced the release of the Hive EV charger. For owners of electric vehicles who wish to better control and manage their charging and costs, the new charger is perfect. The charger, which is the smallest electric car charger currently available and is the size of an A5 notebook, was created in collaboration with EO Charging, one of the top EV charger manufacturers in the UK.

Israeli company XTEND acquires drone startup Performance Rotors

Israeli drone software company XTEND recently announced the acquisition of a Singapore drone startup Performance Rotors. Not revealing the financial terms of the deal, the company said that the move will boost its ability to offer human-guided, remote interactive operations in a range of inspection scenarios, and grow its global business. The combination of the startup's drones and robotics and XTEND's XOS operating system aims to make remote interactive operations possible even in GPS-denied, confined spaces.

tion, the startup envisages having better access to clients across North, West, East, and North-East regions.

Kolkata Urban Development Board to deploy manhole cleaning bots

New Town Kolkata Development Authority has introduced three manhole-cleaning robots to clean the sewerage network across New Town, effectively replacing human labour. The urban development authority has purchased each robot for ₹3.4 million, including the cost of procuring and running a generator for operating the machines, from Kerala-based startup Genrobotics. The waste that clogs

the manhole would be collected by the robotic arms of the robot, called Bandicoot. The machine's gas detection sensors would be able to detect the presence of any toxic gases inside the manholes. The robot's arms can stretch to a length of 1.7 metres to collect trash.

Gautam Solar joins hands with Jinchen to double its solar module capacity

India's leading solar company Gautam Solar recently announced its partnership with Chinese solar equipment company Jinchen. The Indian player plans to add a 500MW tunnel-oxide passivated contact

(TOPCon) manufacturing line from Jinchen, thus expanding its solar module production capacity to 1 GWp (gigawatt peak). The production from this new line is expected to commence by September this year. TOPCon is a technology used in the manufacturing of high-efficiency solar cells; it involves the creation of a passivation layer on both sides of the solar cell.

Xiaomi partners with Optimus Electronics to manufacture audio products in India

Leading smartphone and smart TV brand Xiaomi India recently